

# HARIES PALANIAPPAN

Security Engineer • Red Team Operator • Vulnerability Researcher

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity Engineer with 2+ years of enterprise experience spanning red team operations, application security, cloud security, and regulatory compliance. CRTP-certified Active Directory attacker and Azure Red Team operator. Recognized by Microsoft for discovering a Remote Code Execution (RCE) vulnerability in Microsoft Office and a UAC Bypass - both accepted and patched globally. Acknowledged by Google for a P1-severity bug on Google Cloud infrastructure. National Winner at Smart India Hackathon 2023. Springer-published researcher in insider threat detection. Expert at bridging offensive security with enterprise defence across ISO 27001, SOC 2, PCI-DSS, HITRUST, and NIST CSF frameworks.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Offensive Security:** Penetration Testing • Active Directory Exploitation (CRTP/CRTE) • Azure Red Teaming • Bug Bounty Research • Malware Analysis • DFIR • OSINT • Kali Linux • Metasploit • Burp Suite

**Compliance & GRC:** ISO 27001 • SOC 2 Type II • PCI-DSS Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) • TPRM

**Cloud & Infrastructure:** • AWS • AppSec • API Security

**Languages & Dev:** Python • Flutter/Dart • Java • PHP • SQL/MySQL • Solidity • Bash/Shell • HTML/CSS

**Security Operations:** Threat Intelligence • Vulnerability Management • Incident Response • Risk Assessment • Policy Development • Behavioural Analytics

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Security Analyst

Aug 2025 – Present

Infinite Computer Solutions • Hybrid • Full-Time

- Lead red team engagements and adversarial simulations mapped to MITRE ATT&CK; uncover critical attack paths and misconfigurations across enterprise infrastructure.
- Conduct application security reviews, threat modelling, and Privacy Impact Assessments (PIA) for cloud-hosted enterprise applications.
- Drive ISO 27001, SOC 2 Type II, PCI-DSS, and HITRUST compliance audits; author gap analyses, remediation roadmaps, and NIST CSF risk frameworks.
- Manage TPRM, vendor assessments.

### Associate Developer – Secure Application Engineering

Aug 2023 – Aug 2025

Squadl Technologies • Coimbatore, TN • On-Site

- Delivered Flutter mobile applications with AES encryption, OAuth2 auth, and hardened API security; enforced TLS 1.3 and certificate pinning across all client-server communication.
- Embedded OWASP Mobile Top 10 mitigations in SDLC; led secure code reviews eliminating critical injection, authentication, and authorization vulnerabilities pre-release.

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## NOTABLE PROJECTS & BUG BOUNTY RESEARCH

### Bug Bounty Discoveries

**Microsoft RCE – Office Remote Code Execution** • Microsoft Security Response Centre • Jun 2024 — [msrc.microsoft.com](https://msrc.microsoft.com)

- Discovered a critical unauthenticated Remote Code Execution (RCE) vulnerability in Microsoft Office affecting millions of installations globally. The flaw allowed an attacker to execute arbitrary code on a victim's machine by convincing them to open a specially crafted document. Reported through Microsoft's responsible disclosure program; accepted and resolved globally by Microsoft.

**Microsoft UAC Bypass – Windows Privilege Escalation** • Microsoft Security Response Centre • May 2024 — [msrc.microsoft.com](https://msrc.microsoft.com)

- Identified a critical User Account Control (UAC) Bypass vulnerability in Windows allowing a low-privileged attacker to silently escalate to Administrator without triggering any security prompts. The technique bypassed UAC entirely without relying on known auto-elevation paths. Reported through MSRC; accepted and resolved globally by Microsoft.

## Google Cloud P1 Bug – Infrastructure Security · Google Security Team · Jul 2022 - [bughunters.google.com](https://bughunters.google.com)

- Discovered a P1-severity (critical) security vulnerability directly affecting Google Cloud's official infrastructure. P1 is the highest severity classification in Google's bug bounty program, reserved for issues with direct exploitability and significant impact. Responsibly disclosed to the Google Security Team and officially acknowledged.

## Security Projects

### Sparkout OS – Security-Hardened Windows 11 — Windows Security · Anti-Ransomware · Firewall · VPN

- Hardened Windows 11 OS with pre/post-ransomware protection, COMODO Firewall, no-logs VPN, and Linux subsystem support. Won 1st Prize at KEC Internal Hackathon 2022; designed for legacy hardware with a full enterprise-grade security stack.

GitHub: [github.com/haries-dev/Sparkout-OS](https://github.com/haries-dev/Sparkout-OS)

### Terrorist Tracker Toolkit – OSINT Intelligence Framework — Python · OSINT · Web Scraping · Intelligence Analysis

- Automated OSINT scraper aggregating and correlating open-source intelligence from public platforms for threat actor profiling and law enforcement operations. Built for authorized counterterrorism research at Kongu Engineering College.

GitHub: [github.com/haries-dev/Terrorist-Tracker-Toolkit](https://github.com/haries-dev/Terrorist-Tracker-Toolkit)

### PHANTOM OS – Red/Blue Team Unified Security Platform — OS Security · Red Team · Blue Team

- Custom security OS unifying Red Team attack simulations with Blue Team defence in one platform. Enables full kill-chain execution (initial access → lateral movement → exfiltration) with real-time defence validation.

### Project Lucifer – Advanced Penetration Testing Framework — C# · VB.NET · Zero-Click Exploits

- Authorized immortal spyware framework for corporate pentest engagements featuring zero-click exploit delivery, persistent implants resistant to reboots and AV removal, and covert exfiltration channels. Validated at national cybersecurity competitions.

GitHub: [github.com/haries-dev/Project-Lucifer](https://github.com/haries-dev/Project-Lucifer)

### ADM – Advanced Defense Mechanism — C# · Python · Endpoint Security

- C# enterprise application blocking weaponized USB hacking devices (Rubber Ducky, Bash Bunny) from compromising workstations. Monitors HID signatures in real time, quarantines unauthorized payloads, and alerts security teams before keystroke injection can execute.

GitHub: [github.com/haries-dev/ADM](https://github.com/haries-dev/ADM)

## CERTIFICATIONS

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| ▶ <b>Certified Red Team Professional - Pwned Badge</b> · Altered Security — <a href="https://eu.badgr.com/public/assertions/YBJTrgvmQ765dgJ8vofi0A">eu.badgr.com/public/assertions/YBJTrgvmQ765dgJ8vofi0A</a> | Jun 2025 |
| ▶ <b>Azure Red Teaming Certificate</b> · Altered Security — <a href="https://eu.badgr.com/public/assertions/sGEHgGOFTfK8Py4NRBagng">eu.badgr.com/public/assertions/sGEHgGOFTfK8Py4NRBagng</a>                 | Sep 2025 |
| ▶ <b>DFIR Investigations &amp; Witness Testimony</b> · Cybrary                                                                                                                                                | Nov 2020 |
| ▶ <b>Phishing Prevention Mechanisms</b> · Cybrary                                                                                                                                                             | Nov 2020 |
| ▶ <b>Ethical Hacking Level 1 &amp; 2</b> · CCube                                                                                                                                                              | Oct 2019 |
| ▶ <b>Ethical Hacking Fundamentals</b> · Prompt Infotech, Coimbatore                                                                                                                                           | Oct 2020 |
| ▶ <b>Network &amp; Network Security</b> · Prompt Infotech, Coimbatore                                                                                                                                         | Sep 2020 |

## HONORS & AWARDS

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| ▶ <b>National Winner – Smart India Hackathon 2023</b> · Government of India                                         | Dec 2023 |
| ▶ <b>Best Industrial Mentor – Smart India Hackathon 2023</b> · Gov. of India / Squadl Technologies                  | Dec 2023 |
| ▶ <b>National Finalist – Kavach Cybersecurity Hackathon 2023</b> · Ministry of Home Affairs & Ministry of Education | Aug 2023 |
| ▶ <b>National Finalist – CCTNS Hackathon &amp; Cyber Challenge</b> · National Crime Records Bureau, New Delhi       | Jun 2022 |
| ▶ <b>1st Prize – Internal Hackathon 2022 (Sparkout OS)</b> · Kongu Engineering College                              | Mar 2022 |

## EDUCATION

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Master of Science – Computer Software Engineering</b>                                              | May 2018 – May 2023 |
| <b>Kongu Engineering College, Tamil Nadu, India</b> · GPA: 86.6%                                      |                     |
| <i>Best Project Award 2023 · Best Co-Curricular Award 2023 · IIC Best Student Projects Award 2021</i> |                     |

## PUBLICATION

### USB-Sentinel: A Generalized AIO Software-Assisted Insider Threat Detection Framework - Python · Machine Learning · Behavioural Analytics

- Springer International Publishing (ICDEC 2023 & 2025, DOI: 10.1007/978-981-97-8476-9\_29) enterprise USB threat detection framework with real-time ML anomaly detection, device whitelist/blacklist enforcement, malware sandboxing, and centralized alerting against BadUSB, rogue devices, and keylogger attacks.

Publication Link: [link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-981-97-8476-9\\_29](https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-981-97-8476-9_29).